

MIDWEST PREMIER HEALTH PLAN

P.O. Box 7100 · Chicago, IL 60601 Member Services: 1-800-777-3200 | Appeals: 1-800-777-3201 | Fax: 1-800-777-3202

NOTICE OF ADVERSE BENEFIT DETERMINATION

Date of Notice:	April 2, 2026
Claim Reference #:	MPHP-2026-0058241
Member Name:	Maria L. Fontaine
Member ID:	MPHP-00381629
Date of Birth:	March 22, 1964
Group Number:	GRP-NW-00917
Plan Name:	Midwest Premier PPO 1500
Plan Type:	Fully Insured / State-Regulated

Dear Maria L. Fontaine,

Midwest Premier Health Plan has completed its review of the claim referenced above and has made an adverse benefit determination. This letter explains the reason for the denial, the clinical criteria applied, your appeal rights, and the deadlines you must observe to protect those rights. Please read this letter carefully.

CLAIM DETAILS

Field	Detail	Field	Detail
Treating Provider	Dr. Kevin A. Morrison, MD	Provider NPI	2345678901
Facility	Northwestern Memorial Outpatient	Facility NPI	8765432109
Date of Service	March 10, 2026	Place of Service	Outpatient Radiology (22)
Procedure Performed	MRI Lumbar Spine w/ Contrast	CPT Code	72148
Diagnosis	Low back pain — lumbar radiculopathy	ICD-10 Code	M54.4
Billed Amount	\$3,800.00	Denied Amount	\$3,800.00
Network Status	In-Network	Claim Status	DENIED

REASON FOR DENIAL

Denial Reason Code: CO-50 — These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a medical necessity by the payer.

Our utilization management team conducted a clinical review of the submitted claim and supporting documentation. Based on this review, the requested MRI of the lumbar spine (CPT 72148) does not meet the criteria for medical necessity under your Midwest Premier PPO 1500 plan at this time.

Specifically, our review found that the member has not completed a minimum of six (6) weeks of conservative treatment prior to the imaging request, as required under our Imaging Management Policy IM-SPINE-007. Conservative treatment includes, but is not limited to, physical therapy, chiropractic care, or a documented trial of anti-inflammatory medications. Submission of records showing completion of required conservative therapy may be the basis for an appeal.

CLINICAL CRITERIA APPLIED

This determination was made pursuant to Midwest Premier's Imaging Management Policy IM-SPINE-007, which incorporates MCG Health Guidelines (2025 edition) for spinal imaging. An independent physician reviewer, board-certified in radiology, conducted this clinical review. This denial constitutes a determination that the service does

not meet plan criteria for medical necessity based on documentation submitted.

YOUR APPEAL RIGHTS

Level 1 — Internal Appeal

You have the right to file an internal appeal within 180 days of the date of this notice (deadline: September 29, 2026). Submit your appeal in writing, including any additional clinical documentation, to:

Midwest Premier Health Plan — Appeals Department
P.O. Box 7200, Chicago, IL 60601
Fax: 1-800-777-3202 | Email: appeals@midwestpremier-example.com

Level 2 — External Independent Review

If your internal appeal is denied, you may request an External Independent Review through the Illinois Department of Insurance (IDOI) within 4 months of the internal appeal denial. This review is conducted by an accredited independent review organization and is binding on Midwest Premier Health Plan.

Expedited Review

If your health condition is urgent, you may request an expedited internal appeal. Expedited decisions are rendered within 72 hours of receipt of the request and supporting documentation.

ILLINOIS DEPARTMENT OF INSURANCE

You also have the right to file a complaint with the Illinois Department of Insurance at any time:

Illinois Department of Insurance | 122 S. Michigan Ave, 19th Floor, Chicago, IL 60603
Phone: 1-866-445-5364 | Website: www.insurance.illinois.gov

This notice constitutes an Adverse Benefit Determination under 29 C.F.R. § 2560.503-1 and Illinois Insurance Code § 155.04. This letter does not constitute legal or medical advice. If you have questions, call Member Services at 1-800-777-3200.